

Spotify Hook

Discover effortlessly

Introducing **shorter** clips for **longer** listening

Confused? Instagram, YouTube, and Netflix are nailing it. Why shouldn't we?
Still confused? Join me in meaningfully extracting the geet from Sangeet
Even More confused? So are the users. Well, that's what we are here to solve!

"Our vision is to unlock the potential of human creativity—by giving a million creative artists the opportunity to live off their art and billions of fans the opportunity to enjoy and be inspired by it"

Spotify's mission

"Our view is how can we bring music into every moment of someone's life"

Daniel EK, Co-founder

"Let other media behemoths battle for eyeballs, Spotify is going after the world's eardrums."

Steven Bertoni, Forbes



SPOTIFY USAGE STATS

406M Active users

148 min Avg daily listening time

STUFF TO LISTEN TO

3.2 M Podcasts

80M Tracks

4B Playlists

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Increase the time spent listening on the app

PROBLEM DECODE

Time spent listening is the time spent by user streaming music, podcasts or audiobooks.

Time spent listening↑ = Total time on app – **time spent not listening**↓

When & why do people listen to audio content?

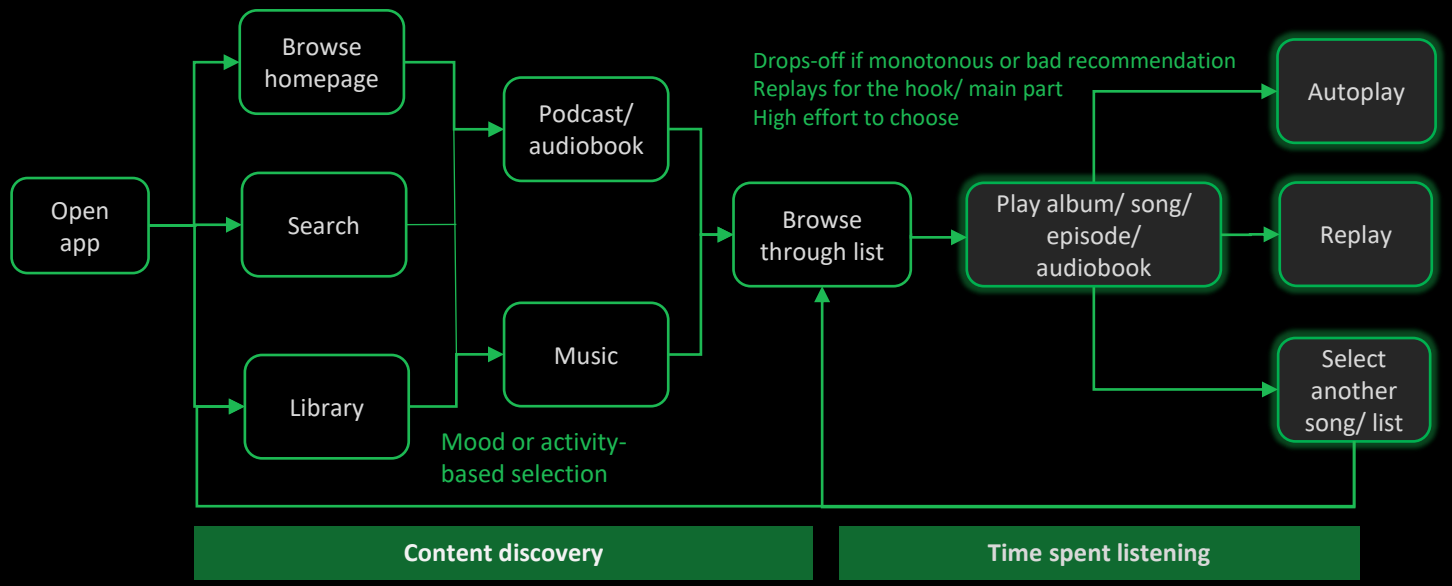
Music

- Uplift mood
- Leisure
- As background music while studying, working out, cooking, travelling
- In social settings eg party, long drive..
- Recommendations by others
- Before sleeping

Podcast/ Audiobook

- While travelling, cooking, walking, before sleeping
- For educating oneself
- Audiobook – as an alternative to reading

USER FLOW



PROBLEM ANALYSIS

Music	Podcast
Pain points • Choice overload • No preview for quick decision • Monotonous recommendations • Manually chooses a part of the song to check the vibe	• No preview for quick decision to disover amongst 4B+ options • Needs to read the description to understand context, which leads to a break in the listening flow • Discovery process is not smooth and efficient, high effort • No audio solution for preface of a book

PROBLEM BREAKDOWN

Time spent not listening on app = **content discovery (browsing and deciding what to listen to)**

Time spent listening = #Users x Avg listening time/listener x Play button CTR
Play button CTR = (#autoplays + #manually played)/#play buttons on screen during the session

#autoplays -> similar music of your taste -> high engagement as Spotify is the king of recommendations
#manually played -> discover music + podcasts while listening (when user is bored of recommendations/ selection) -> great scope of improvement as users are overloaded with choices and find it hard to discover new type of content

USER PERSONA



Piyush |28
Male| Consultant | Delhi

- Spends an avg of 3 hours daily listening to music and 1 hour on podcasts
- Uses Spotify, YT music for streaming

"I love Spotify for its recommendations. Although there are playlists available for all types of requirements yet, discovering and exploring music requires much browsing and searching. "

Pains points
- Does not have time to juggle between options to explore music
- Listens to the first 1-2 minutes to choose podcast which does not give a clear context of the topic
- Does not want to limit his exposure to new music to recommendations

Needs
- Wants quick discovery options
- Wants to listen to meaningful podcasts only and save time discovering podcasts of his choice

USER INTERVIEWS

"I create 3 reels/shorts per week. For me, finding the right track is a challenge. I spend a lot of time searching for good music and the main part of the song. "
Radhini, 24 | India | Fashion Influencer

"Even with a travel playlist, we end up searching through different albums while travelling to match the vibe. We often change song after every minute to avoid boredom "
Simran, 27 |Udaipur | Chef

" I listen to youtube albums for current affairs while having breakfast. Since I don't watch them, I prefer to listen to audio podcasts but it's time-consuming to find relevant podcasts on Spotify"
Lashit, 30 |London | Software developer

"I listen to fast music while working out, and instrumental music while studying. Hence, I don't find Spotify's recommendations and discover weekly playlists helpful during my leisure time.
Suhani, *22 |New Hempshire | Student*

MARKET RESEARCH

- Research suggests that nearly 20% of songs available on the app have never been played.
- According to Music Machinery, about 35% of listeners will skip a song within the first 30 seconds and nearly half of listeners skip a song before it's over.

PROBLEM THREADS ON SOCIAL

I understand that Spotify is sleek and that its mobile-first design works seamlessly on the go. But using YouTube to find new tunes doesn't leave you feeling bombarded, or like you have to consult special features meant specifically for the discovery of new artists. Personally speaking, I've never listened to an artist on Spotify using shuffle without eventually hearing songs from *other* artists that I really don't like.

YouTube's algorithm feels a little bit less overbearing, since you'll get suggestions for new tracks at the end of a video instead of an immediate switch to a song you didn't select. Of course, this is contingent on whether or not you've turned autoplay off, but it remains true that you'll stay more within the musical realm of your choosing.

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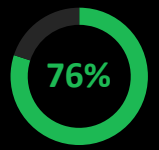
What to Listen to?

with as a music fan is how to narrow down what to listen to, and the as I have the history of recorded music at my fingertips.

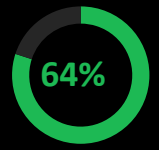
eaming service toolbar, or the shelf of records, CDs and tapes, often I go of 20 or so things I'd like to listen to off the top of my head, and would could. But I have to pick one, and often I feel like I pick one that doesn't r headspace.

I have devised some strategies for narrowing things down - going through best albums lists, or having a playlist of albums where I listen to the first one that comes up on shuffle. But I have trouble disregarding the opportunity cost of all the other music I am not listening to when choosing one album out of many. I am open to any suggestions you guys have or use to get past it, and get my head into whatever it is I am currently listening to.

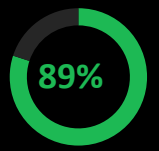
USER SURVEY



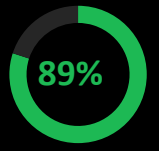
Find it time-consuming to discover a new song



Listen to different genres based on different activity or mood



Skim songs to discover



Face choice overload while searching for podcasts

What is the true problem?

The current content discovery process is time-consuming (searching, browsing, and selecting to play a 3 min song or searching for the main part of the song). Music recommendations become monotonous and boring after a point, which leads to drop-offs and limited listening time.

Who is facing this problem

Users with less time to discover content while performing other activities want quick discovery.

What is the value generated?

USERS

Hassle-free and quick content discovery

BUSINESS

More engagement & retention. + Reduced churn rate -> Higher ad revenue from free users + Higher conversion to premium subscriptions.

CREATORS

Higher visibility + Higher reach to audience + Higher repeats per song -> Higher revenue for the creator

Why should we solve it now?

- The global music streaming market is expected to grow at a compound annual growth rate **of 14.7% from 2022 to 2030** to reach USD 103.07 billion by 2030.
- 29% of Spotify users are millennials.
- Spotify is leading its way through technology and solving customer problems, but with Youtube and Instagram changing user behavioural pattern, Spotify must adapt as well. To gain higher market share, Spotify needs to be both “Vitamins” and “Painkillers”. Youtube is far ahead in terms of usage with 2B active users
- Spotify targets **1 Billion listeners by 2030**, double of current!
- Currently, **podcasts account for only 7%** of all listening hours on platform

Job-to-be-done framework

When I want to discover a new genre of music or listen to a relevant podcast while multi tasking
But I don’t have time to go through a huge number of options on Spotify
Help me find music or podcast effortlessly and quickly
So that I can explore new content

ACTIVITY TRACKER

- Tracks activity and activity history through mobile (Google Fit/ Apple Health, maps, focus apps, etc.)and smartwatch only when the app is opened
- Recommends a radio playlist based on your pace, age, time of the day, type of activity, and connected device by using a prompt like “Hey, wanna listen to popular yoga songs? Do you have any specifications?”
- If user selects yes, he/she is presented with a mic/type option to call out words like “romantic classical English piano covers” The playlist syncs its pace with user’s activity and gradually shifts its rhythm based on temp, intensity etc
- For a slow-paced task, user can also be prompted to select podcast.

SPOTIFY HOOK

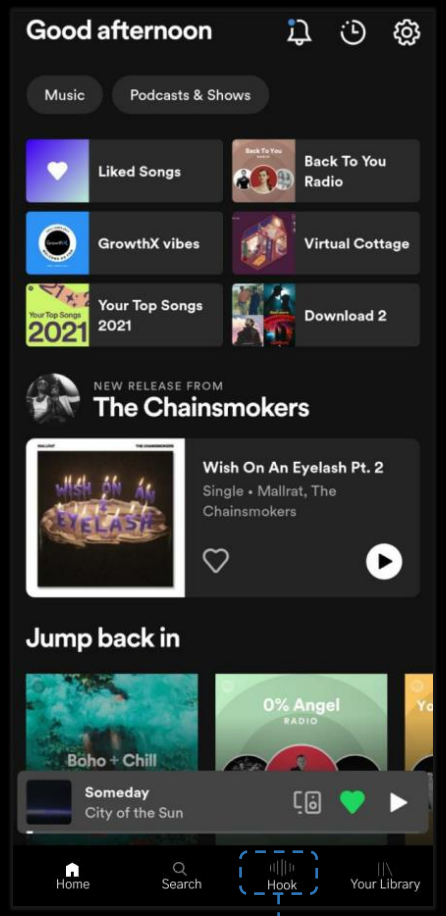
- Short-form audio content for fast discovery. A simple yet powerful solution to make content discovery quick and effortles while keeping the user hooked to the platform.
- A feature to view short clips of music/ podcasts/audiobooks and provide a filter and sort option for highly specific content, user can like, add to list or directly stream full audio.
- Default timer setting will be 90 seconds, but user can choose the length as per their need.
- Music – Either play the most played part of the song (based on current data) or a creator-specified range. Implement using play density graph of timelines and drag event data of position slider handle, Deep learning model can be trained with Spotify’s massive database to better detect these areas.
- Podcast – creator-specified range
- Audiobook – preface/ chapter 1 audio version
- Free plan will have audio ads, Premium will be ad-free

POPULAR STREAM

- Currently, Spotify has generic Spotify curated “Top 50” like playlists or user-created “Top 100” like playlists.
- Addition of a filter based on genre (topic for podcast) and sort based on the number of streams on top of Spotify curated popularity playlist or radio, as well as podcasts, will help users to discover new music organically.
- Filter will reduce drop-offs and sort will help discover popular music.

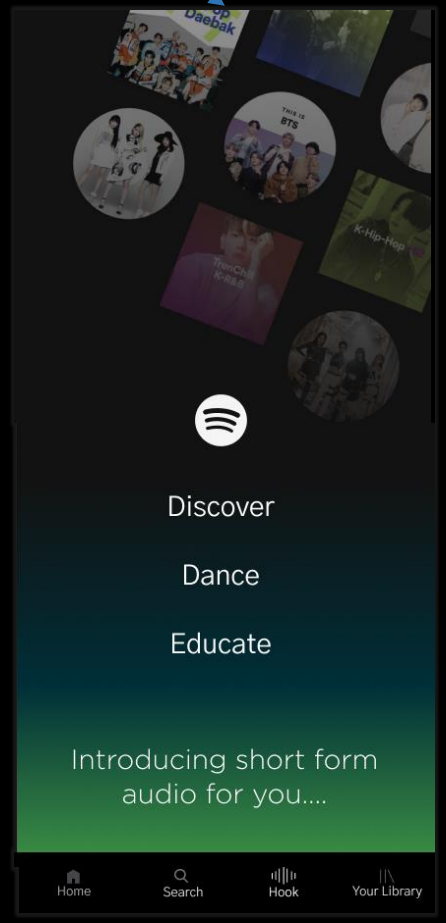
	Reach	Ease of use	Engagement	Cost Implication	Impact (listening time)
Activity Tracker	MID Hesitation to share data + Limited to specific tasks	MID Mic issue / Typing effort	LOW Activity specific	LOW	HIGH Relevant music
Spotify Hook	HIGH Direct access through footer	HIGH Familiarity with shorts, reels..	HIGH Short content – high dopamine	LOW	HIGH Users choose as per need, less churn out
Popular Streams	MID Not directly visible, new user acquisition is a challenge	HIGH Simple filter and sort	MID Very specific	LOW	MID Limited reach

*Assuming infinite tech bandwidth



Hooks icon on the footer to ensure high visibility

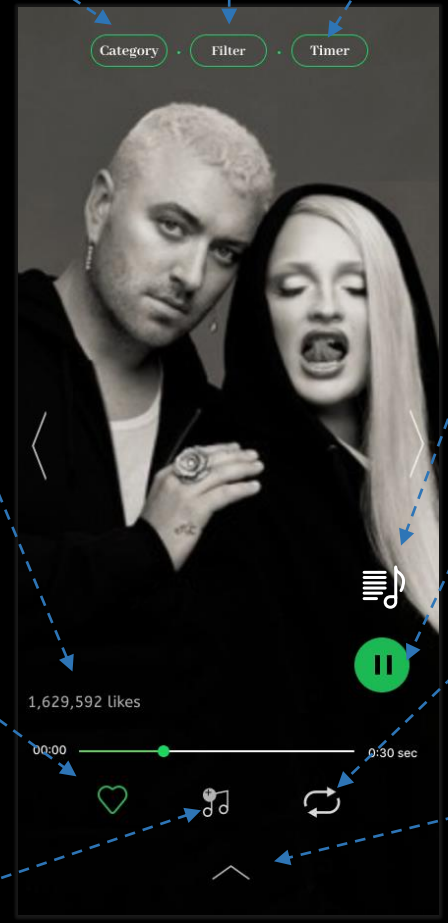
First time users presented with value proposition, User swipes up to open the feature, swipes down to close



Category – music, podcast, audiobook (button to select one or more), default - all

Filter to chose based on genre, mood, language, activity etc, If podcast is selected user gets topic as well for filter

Timer : 30s, 50s, 90s (default)



Likes – sum of hook likes + full audio likes

Like – full song/ episode gets added to the current liked playlist

Adds full song to a specific playlist

Stream full song/ podcast now

Pause hook

Replay hook

Opens the list of hooks

Default (no filter) – hooks of popular (based on likes) and latest songs in your country



After swiping up, user is presented with the list of hooks

Menu features
1. Go the album (original album of the artist)
2. Never show this hook
3. Don't repeat hook
4. View artist

Quick basic filters
Trending, Latest(include audio from small creators as well), Spotify Exclusive (great visibility for new artists)



Advanced filters
User can select based on his choice
There are several possibilities for category of filters
Filters are dynamic – based on category(music/podcast/ audiobook select)



Podcast topics can have subtopics as well
Eg, when the user selects Health as a topic, pop up slides from bottom to present user with sub topics

As podcasts grow on Spotify, this feature will help user to listen to podcast previews on very specific topics

Pop up can be closed by :
1. Swiping down
2. Pressing anywhere outside
3. Pressing close

Close – kept to denote end of list

NORTH STAR METRIC	• **Listening time on hooks** • **Overall increase in listening time**
ACQUISITION	• Average swipe ups of hook homepage(for new user) per number of visits weekly/ monthly • #creators creating hooks/ Total #creators
ADOPTION	• Average CTR of hook button(organic + through push notification) • Average CTR of the “stream full audio” button • Average CTR of category button • Average CTR of filters (each filter) • Average CTR of time button\ • Average CTR of like button • #number of creators specifying range for hooks/ #Total creators • DAU/MAU
ENGAGEMENT	• Average listening time of audio discovered through hook • #hooks played per session • Time spent on hook/ Total time on the app • Listening time after filtering/ Total time on hook • Listening time after category selection/ Total time on hook • Average time per hook • #replays per hook
BUSINESS	• Revenue from ads on hook • Revenue from conversion to premium through hook • Listen through rate (percentage of listeners who heard ad in full) • Audio impressions (No of times ad is heard) • CSAT score for hook
PERFORMANCE	• Average load time – to open the app • Drop-off rate of users within 5 reels • Audio quality of hook/audio quality of main audio • Buffer rate while swiping

SECOND ORDER THINKING

- Hook may lead to change in user behaviour, shifting user preference to short audio content
- This feature may lead to the rise of audio creators, which would require a separate monetization strategy
- Spotify may start charging more from creators owing to higher visibility and discovery of content
- This product can be expanded to a daily news feature

PITFALLS - MITIGATIONS

- Quality of content may get hampered with more creators creating only short audio
  - Spotify needs to maintain a quality check on creators using ML models to handle spam and low-quality music based on a few standards.
- Users shifting to music-only competitors
  - Marketing the value proposition on social media, Spotify ads or homepage carefully based on different user persona
- Addition of a video preview in future for higher revenue
  - This must be beta tested thoroughly, as it can prove to be counterproductive
- Avid music lovers may get agitated about another reel-like product
  - A toggle to turn of the Hook feature in settings
- Reduced listening of full songs
  - Remind user to listen to user-created albums through dedicated slot on homepage or push notifications